

December 2, 2024

521 Wall St., Suite 100  
Seattle, WA 98121

### **A Letter of Recommendation for Mr. Clark Jason Ngo**

#### **Dear the Admission Committee:**

It is a pleasure to write a letter of recommendation for Mr. Clark Jason Ngo for the University of Washington Graduate School's Information School PhD program in Information Science for Autumn 2025.

First, I would like to provide a brief overview of my professional background. Next, I will explain how long and in what capacity I have known Mr. Ngo. I will then discuss his work experiences and qualities and share my thoughts on how he will perform in your program, particularly in relation to the iSchool's interdisciplinary approach to the study of information. Finally, I will conclude my recommendation for Mr. Ngo's application.

#### **About Evaluator**

I am Sam Chung, a Professor and the Dean of the School of Technology and Computing at the City University of Seattle (CityU) in Washington. I joined CityU in June 2018, prior to which I served as the Director of the School of Information Systems and Applied Technologies at the College of Applied Sciences and Arts (CASA) at Southern Illinois University Carbondale for four years. I held the position of full professor during my time at CASA.

Before my tenure at SIUC, I worked for fourteen years at the Institute of Technology at the University of Washington in Tacoma. I began my career there as an assistant professor of Computer Science in 2001 and was tenured and promoted to Associate Professor in 2007. In 2009, I founded a new Bachelor of Science in Information Technology degree program at UW Tacoma and served as the founding Program Coordinator until 2014.

I earned my Master's and Ph.D. in Computer Science from George Washington University and the University of South Florida, respectively.

#### **How long and in what capacity have I known Mr. Ngo**

I have known Mr. Ngo for over seven years. I first met him on my first day at the City University of Seattle in June 2018, where he was working as a student worker at the reception desk. When I learned that he was planning to pursue an MS in Computer Science (MSCS), I was excited to discuss his study plans with him. Given Mr. Ngo's background in Finance, we talked about how the new knowledge and skills he would acquire through the MSCS—such as blockchain, cloud computing, and cybersecurity—could be applied to his finance background. Conversely, we also discussed how his undergraduate studies and work experiences in Finance could enhance the analytical aspects of computing.

I began working with Mr. Ngo when he was hired in a role similar to that of a Graduate Teaching Assistant. After his graduation, I hired him for a project manager position after securing additional funding for the AWS Apprentice Program. He consistently demonstrated excellence in teaching, research, service, and support for his peers. Following the first year of the Optional Practical Training (OPT) program, he began working as a contractor for eBay. Eventually, he returned to CityU to pursue his MBA.

### Mr. Ngo's work experiences, qualities, and expected performance

I have encouraged Mr. Ngo to pursue a Doctoral program at your university instead of an MBA because I believe he would be an excellent fit for the iSchool's interdisciplinary approach to the study of information. Mr. Ngo has a strong background in advanced research, particularly in understanding human interactions with information and exploring its social and technological implications.

During his MSCS program at CityU, Mr. Ngo made significant contributions as one of the founding members of my Smart and Secure Computing research group. In my graduate-level class on Secure Systems and Programs, he and his team enhanced their project to the point of submission as a conference proceeding. They proposed improvements to the quality and security of modern software systems' backends, tailored for the serverless computing architecture. Their paper was subsequently accepted for publication in the Journal of the Colloquium for Information Systems Security Education (CISSE) following Mr. Ngo's presentation at CISSE 2019 in Las Vegas, Nevada.

In 2019, I invited Mr. Ngo to participate in FinTech research due to his background in finance. This field necessitated an interdisciplinary approach that included business professionals. The resulting paper, "Crossing the Chasm between FinTech and Finance Professionals: A Grounded Analysis of Blockchain and Cloud Computing for Future FinTech Information Systems," was presented at the 5th International Conference on Accounting and Finance (ICOAF-2019). This conference occurred on July 13-14, 2019, at the Grand Tourane Hotel in Da Nang City, Vietnam.

In his capstone project, Mr. Ngo focused on understanding human involvement in full-stack web development. He advanced his capstone and published it in the Proceedings of the Conference on Information Systems Applied Research (ISSN Vol. 2167, p. 1508) in 2021. His paper proposed strategies to reduce the barriers to entry for open-source projects and full-stack web development. The results indicated that incorporating architectural modeling into the documentation of an open-source full-stack development project significantly decreases the learning curve for developers. This approach provides a visual representation that helps developers quickly grasp and understand high-level concepts.

After returning to CityU, he recently assisted my school as a teaching assistant (TA). His primary responsibility was to enhance the programming exercises related to the practicum. He helped me concentrate on creating and advancing new knowledge using Generative AI, which will significantly positively impact full-stack mobile app development. The first outcome, "Enterprise AI Course: Cloud-Based Full-Stack DevSecOps with Retrieval-Augmented Generation," was presented at UKC 2024 in San Francisco, CA, from August 21 to 24, 2024.

### Summary

In conclusion, I strongly recommend Mr. Ngo for **your degree program** without any reservations. Based on the above evidence, I believe Mr. Ngo will expand his future by studying in your doctoral program. If you have questions about him, don't hesitate to contact me at **chungsam@cityu.edu** anytime. I bet Mr. Ngo will be a great asset to your program.

Respectfully,

*Sam Chung*  
Sam Chung, Ph.D.